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Underground, Soundproof Death Chambers DEMANDS MOUNT TO ABOLISH WAUPUN PRISON "SCREAMERS"



Underground, soundproof cells, known as "screamers," under construction at Waupun State Prison outside Milwaukee, Wisconsin. A petition campaign is underway for the abolition of what inmates are terming the "death chambers."

(Milwaukee, Wisc.) - The Milwaukee Chapter of the Black Panther Party reports that it is receiving overwhelmingly favorable support in its organizing efforts to abolish the new underground and soundproof "death chambers" presently under construction at nearby Waupun State Prison.

Since mid-June, when the Milwaukee Chapter called its first community meeting on this issue, over 5,000 signatures on petitions demanding the abolishment of the "death chambers" have been collected (see page 22), and correspondence has been received from as far away as Richmond, Virginia, and Tiburon, California, indicating that concern and support is mounting nationwide.

In addition, working in conjunction with progressive state Assemblyman Lloyd A. Barbee, one of several Black legislators who have signed and supported the petition, arrangements are being made for the coordinator of the Milwaukee Chapter, Ronald Starks, to address the Wisconsin state legislature when the signed petitions are presented to that body.

Last week, in response to distortions and misrepresentations of a prison inmate hunger strike called to protest the "death chambers" construction, the Milwaukee Chapter released a press statement, aired on WAWA, a local Black radio station.

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